

IELTS FOUNDATION 101

Lecture 1. Line Graphs

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A. Structure

I. Introduction

* ***Start your Introduction with:***

- “The line graph depicts/indicates/illustrates” + Theme + Place (optional) + Time (optional). “The unit is measured in” + ...
- “The line graph/ bar chart/table/pie chart/map/layout/etc.” + “gives information about” + Theme + Place (optional) + Time (optional). “The unit is measured in” + ...

* ***Theme (paraphrased):***

- The part lies between “The line graph below describes” and place/time (optional)

- **Ways to paraphrase Theme:**

- + Using synonyms
- + Changing grammatical structures: active voice ⇔ passive voice; relative clauses
- + Changing word forms: nouns (main) ⇔ verbs => different grammatical structures

II. Overview (Outstanding trends & quickly compare)

- “Overall,” + the given figures/data/statistics + depict/reveal + **General trend(s)**/it is evident that +

General trend(s)

- “Overall,” + **X factor is the most/least popular compared to the others.**

* ***General trend(s):***

- ***Verbs***

- + X factor + Verb (trend) + preposition + time
- + The figure(s)/data/statistic(s) for X factor + Verb (trend) + preposition + time
- + The amount/the number/the quantity of sth...

- ***Nouns***

- + A/an ... trend (an increase) in X factor + is witnessed/seen/recorded/observed + preposition + time
- + A/an ... trend (a decrease) + is witnessed/seen/recorded/observed in X factor + preposition + time
- + Time witness(es)/see(s)/record(s)/experience(s) + a/an ... trend (a growth) in X factor
- + There + be (is/are/will be) + a/an ... trend in X factor + preposition + time

III. Body

Divide the Body into 2 paragraphs based on given years.

- **Para 1:** the first years

- **Para 2:** the rest

* **Arrange sentences properly:**

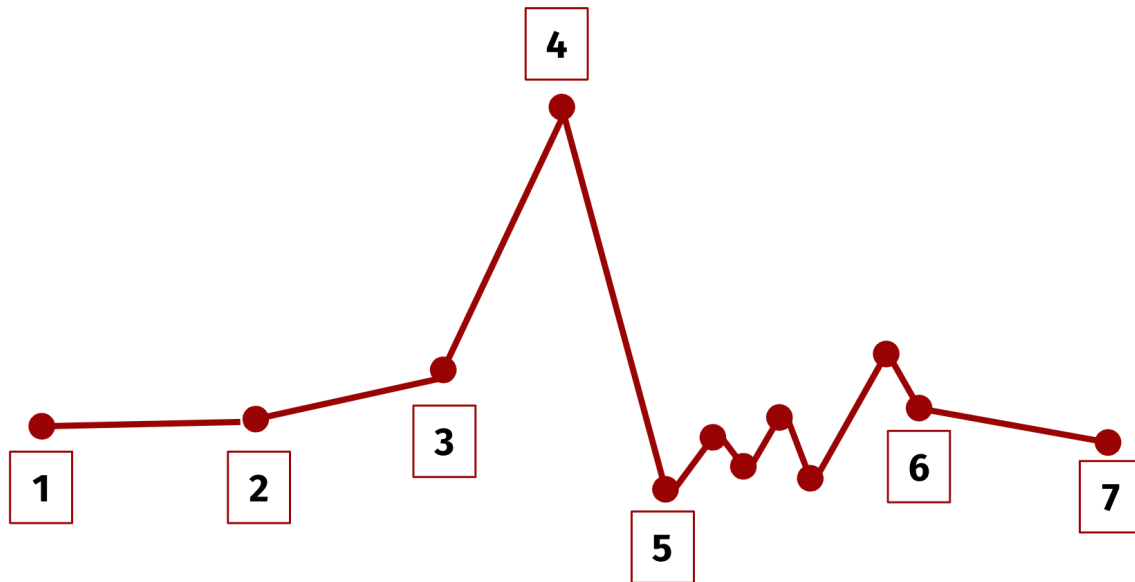
“Verb” sentence => “noun” sentence” => “verb” sentence => “noun” sentence ...

* **Factors which can play a role as a subject:**

- Data themselves: 2 millions of oil barrels
- Years: The year 1982; the period between...
- X: The oil production; The oil consumption

- The figure/statistic/data for X
- The amount of N(uncountable)
- The number/quantity of N
- There is/was ... (relative clause)

B. Expressions



1. Trend Language

1.1. Verbs

1-2:

- remain unchanged/stable/constant/unaltered (+ at data)
- stabilise/level off (+ data)

2-3:

- slightly/slowly/modestly/gently/gradually increase (to + data)
- increase/rise/grow/escalate/climb

3-4:

- swell to + data
- surge/soar/jump/skyrocket (to + data)
- dramatically/markedly/significantly/considerably/substantially/staggeringly/sharply/rapidly/steeply increase (to + data)

4:

- peak at + data

4-5:

- plunge/plummet (to + data)
- dramatically/markedly/significantly/considerably/substantially/staggeringly/sharply/rapidly/steeply decrease (to + data)

5-6:

- wildly/greatly/significantly fluctuate (>< slightly fluctuate)
- fluctuate/vary/become unstable

6-7:

- slightly/slowly/modestly/gently/gradually decrease (to + data)
- decrease/fall/dip/decline/drop/shrink (to + data)

1.2. Nouns

1-2:

- no change/a period of stability (+ at data)
- reach/hit a plateau (+ at data)
- maintain a value at + data

2-3:

- slight/slow/modest/gentle/gradual increase (to + data)
- increase/rise/growth/escalation/increment/upward trend

3-4:

- surge (to + data)
- dramatic/marked/significant/considerable/substantial/staggering/sharp/rapid/steep increase (to + data)

4:

- reach the highest point/reach a peak at + data

5:

- hit bottom/hit a trough/hit an all-time low/reach the lowest point at + data

4-5:

- plunge/plummet (to + data)
- dramatic/markedly/significant/considerable/substantial/staggering/sharp/rapid/steep decrease (to + data)

5-6:

- wild/great/significant fluctuation (around + data/from...to...) >< slight fluctuation
- fluctuation/variation

6-7:

- slight/slow/modest/gentle/gradual decrease (to + data)
- decrease/fall/dip/decline/drop (to + data)

2. Describing Numbers

* *Verbs/Phrases*

- occupy = make up = account for = comprise = constitute: chiếm (+ %; $\frac{2}{3}$, $\frac{1}{3}$, etc.)

* *Prepositions*

- at ...% (indicates the exactly given number; e.g. stay steady at 20%)
- to...&% (indicates the number after a rise or a decrease; e.g. increase to 20%)
- between... and... (usually used to indicate time and with “**fluctuate**”; e.g. fluctuate between 20% and 45%/fluctuate around...)
- a rise *from 14% to 30%* = a rise of 16% (= 30 -14); a decrease *from 43% to 21%* = a decrease of 22% (“of” is used to indicate the gap between two figures of an object and preceded by a noun)
- grow *from 14% to 30%* = grow by 16%; fall *from 43% to 21%* = fall by 22% (“by” is used to indicate the gap between two figures of an object and preceded by a verb)

E.g. The consumption of coca gradually increased from **200 thousand** in 1990 to **225 thousand cans in** 1995 = The consumption of coca gradually increased **by 25 thousand cans** from 1990 to 1995.

3. Linking Words/Phrases

* **Opening**

- In detail,.../As can be observed from the graph,.../It can be seen from the graph that...

* **Connecting information**

- Moreover,.../Furthermore,.../Additionally,.. /In addition,.../Besides,...

- It is noticeable that...

- Similarly,.../Likewise,...

* **Contrasting and comparing**

- However/Nevertheless,...

- By contrast/On the contrary/In contrast,...

- In contrast with X, Y....

- While X..., Y.../Whereas X..., Y...

- X..... Meanwhile, Y...

- Although X..., Y...

4. Comparison Methods

One sentence should contain 2 clauses, one to report data and one to compare.

- **With the object itself:**

+ The figure for X was ...% in 2000, doubling/tripling its (original) value/its (original) number in 1995

+ The figure for X was ...% in 2000, ...% higher/lower than its (original) value/its (original) number in 1995

+ The figure for X was ...% in 2000, twice its (original) value in 1995.

+ The figure for X was ...% in 2000, twice/three times as high/many/much as its (original) value in 1995.

+ The figure for X was ...% in 2000, followed by an increase/a period of growth to ...%/followed by a period of stability/plateau in/until 2005.

+ The figure for X was ...% in 2000 before falling to/swelling to ...% 2005.

+ The figure for X was ...% in 2000, standing at the highest/top rank/position/place among all = The figure for X was ...% in 2000, making it the highest/largest/greatest figure/number compared to the others.

+ There was a twofold/threefold increase/decrease in X factor in 2000 compared to its value in 1995. = A twofold increase was witnessed in X factor from 1995 to 2000, from ...% to ...%/of...% respectively.

+ There was a significant/ slight increase of...% in X factor from 1995 to 2000.

- **With other objects at a time point/during a period of time:**

+ In 2000, the figure for X was ...%, followed><preceded by Y which was/with ...%.

+ In 2000, the figure for X was ...%, doubling/tripling that of Y = In 2000, the figure for X was ...%, twice/three times as high as that of Y which was/with...%.

+ In 2000, the figure for X was ...%, ...% higher/lower than Y with ...%

+ In 2000, the figure for X was ...%, one third/two thirds of Y which was/with ...%.

+ In 2000, the figure for X was ...%, standing at the highest/top position and being followed/preceded by Y which was/with ...%.

+ Although the figure for X fell to...% from 1995 to 2000, it remained higher than those of the others/it remained its highest rank compared to the others.

- + During 10 years since 1995, while X experienced a significant growth of...%, the figure for Y sharply fell to...% in 2005.
- + In the UK, the least amount of budget was allocated for cars **compared to/as opposed to** perfume in France.

- Same trend:

- + Both X and Y followed a similar trend/style/pattern as they declined to ...% and ...% in 2000 before reaching a peak in 2005 with ...% and ...% respectively/in turn/each.
- + Both X and Y shared virtually identical figures, with ...% and ...%

- Opposite trend:

- + While X experienced an upward trend/while the figure for X increased, a reverse/opposite pattern was recorded for Y.
- + While X experienced an upward trend/while the figure for X increased, a reverse/opposite pattern was seen/witnessed/shown/presented in Y.

5. Time referencing

- From the beginning of this period,
- From June to December = Between June to December,
- During the first/second half of this period,
- Over a period of ... years, from... to ...

6. Making forecasts in the future

- X is/are/seems likely to...
- X is/are estimated to/expected to/predicted to/anticipated to/forecast to...
- There is an estimation/expectation/prediction/anticipation/forecast that X would...
- X is planned to.../projected to... (maps)

a. Intro:

- The graph depicts..., and forecasts trends until 2101.
- The graph depicts..., with a prediction for 2101.

b. Overview:

- Describe trends based on specific time scales: **past - present** (present perfect tense) + **future** (future tense)

c. Body:

- **Para 1:** Describe trends and data in the **past - past** (past simple tense) or **past - present** (present perfect tense)
- **Para 2:** latest year in the **past - future** or **present - future** (forecast sentences)